# Mesopotamia & Sumer -- Key Words

Name: _____

**Word bank:** alliance · artisan · city-state · cradle of civilization · cuneiform · epic · Fertile Crescent · hereditary · irrigation · Mesopotamia · monarchy · polytheism · scribe · silt · surplus · ziggurat

Write the word from the word bank that matches each meaning.

1. "the land between the rivers" (Greek); between the Tigris and Euphrates Rivers

   _____

2. A city and the lands around it, with its own government, not part of a larger state

   _____

3. A curving strip of good farmland from the Mediterranean Sea to the Persian Gulf

   _____

4. A government ruled by a king

   _____

5. A large temple; the name means "to rise high"; the top was the god's home

   _____

6. A long poem that tells the story of a hero

   _____

7. A name for Mesopotamia: the beginning of organized human society

   _____

8. A skilled worker who makes things like cloth, pottery, tools, and weapons

   _____

9. An agreement to help each other and protect common interests

   _____

10. An extra amount (of food)

    _____

11. An official record keeper

    _____

12. Passed down in a family: when the king died, his son took over

_____

13. Small particles of soil left behind by floods; very good for farming

_____

14. Sumerian writing made of wedge-shaped marks cut into damp clay with a sharp reed

_____

15. Watering crops by digging canals that carry water from a water source to the fields

_____

16. Worshipping many gods

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